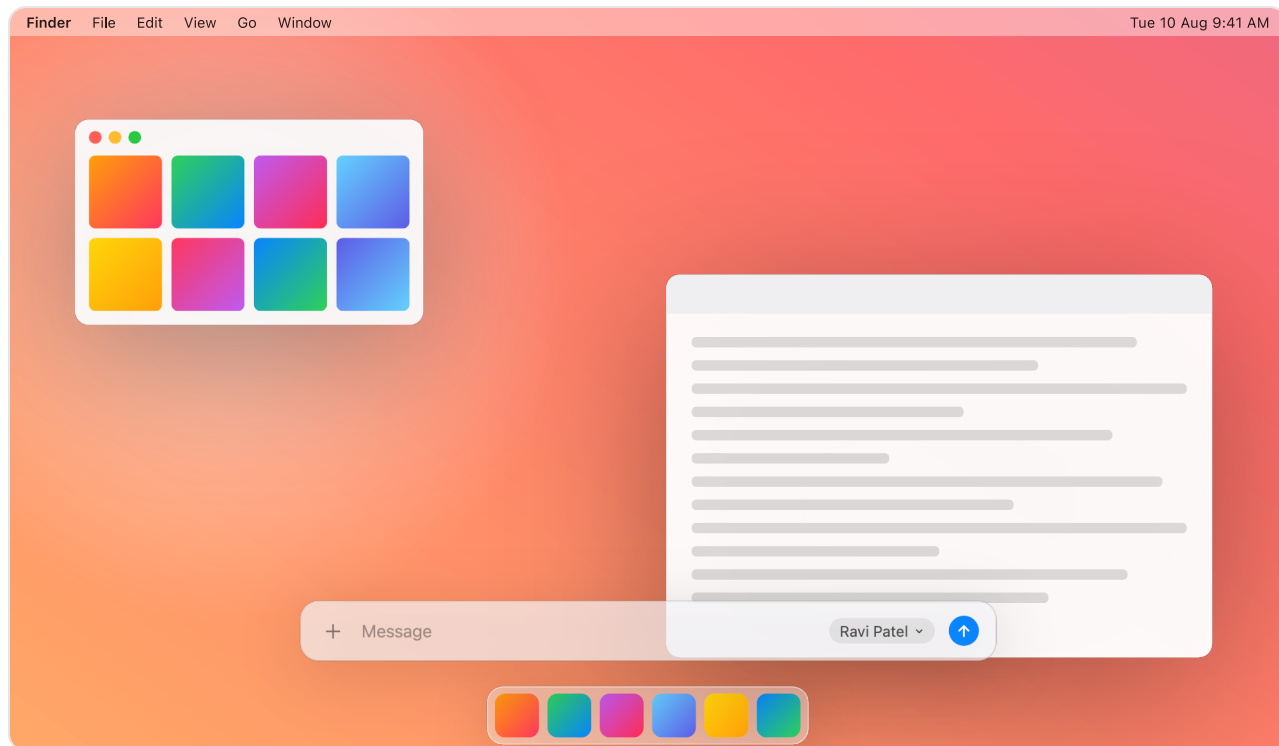


The four decisions

Everything below is settled. Each block shows the shipping treatment at real size with its measurements; the link at its right opens every option that was considered for that part, with the reasoning that ruled the others out.

01 Overlay bar 1b · utility weight, three-quarter Spotlight · bottom-anchored

[All 4 weights →](#)



bar 600×52 pt = 0.397 screen width $\times$ 0.053 screen height (screen 1512×982 pt)

radius 16 pt = 0.308 bar height · pad 14 pt horiz = 0.269 H · controls 26 pt = 0.500 H · gap 12 pt = 0.231 H · placeholder 15 pt = 0.288 H

stroke 0.5 pt = 0.010 H @ 9% light / 12% dark · shadow 0 10 28 @ 20% light / 42% dark · shown at 58%

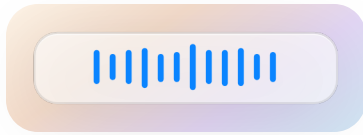
PLACEMENT · bottom edge 118 pt above the screen bottom = 0.120 screen height = 2.27 bar heights

Dock occupies the bottom 84 pt = 0.086 screen height · clearance bar to Dock 34 pt = 0.035 screen height = 0.654 bar height

The hard limit that came out of this: a full-perimeter stroke crossing roughly 1 pt at 15% opacity is the point where the bar stops reading as a system affordance and starts reading as an app window. Stay under it.

The bar now sits at the bottom and the HUD stays at the top, so the two surfaces never occupy the same region and the composed state is resolved. Nothing else about the bar changed; only the anchor moved, from top edge at 26% of screen height to bottom edge at 12%.

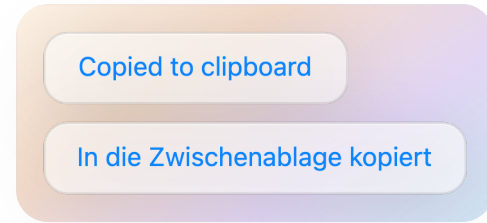
LIVE · 152 × 36 pt



SILENCE · noise floor, drifting

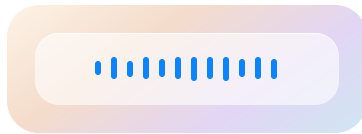
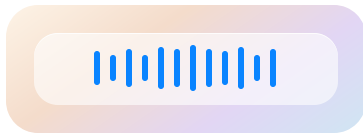


COMPLETE · WIDTH FOLLOWS THE STRING



en 152 pt (floor) · de 213 pt (1.40 ×)

REDUCE MOTION · quantised, 8 Hz



12 bars · 3.5 pt wide, r 1.75, fully round caps · 4.5 pt gap · total 91.5 pt = 60% of HUD width, centred symmetric about centre · compressed $v^{0.5}$ · peak 28 pt = 0.78 H · resting 3.5–6.7 pt, uneven and drifting, never looping

HUD height 36 pt, fixed · radius 12 pt = 0.333 H · liquid glass, light mode: fill 62% white, blur 34 pt = 0.944 H, saturate 180%, inner top highlight 0.5 pt @ 85% white · stroke 0.5 pt = 0.014 H @ 9% black · shadow 0 6 18 @ 16% · centred, top edge 8% of screen height

WIDTH · intrinsic: string width + 16 pt padding each side (0.444 H each, 0.889 H total), floored at 152 pt = 4.22 H, capped at 320 pt = 8.89 H = 0.212 screen width

en 119 pt string → 151 pt, floored to 152 pt (1.00 ×) · de 181 pt → 213 pt (1.40 ×) · fr 177 pt → 209 pt (1.38 ×) · es 166 pt → 198 pt (1.30 ×) · nl 160 pt → 192 pt (1.26 ×) · ja 192 pt → 224 pt (1.47 ×)

width change animated 220 ms, ease-out, from the centre so the HUD stays optically centred throughout

Reduce Motion: 8 Hz sample, 125 ms hold, no interpolation, heights snapped to 3.5 / 8 / 13 / 18 / 23 / 28 pt

The completion string no longer sets the width; it is set by whichever is wider, the string plus its padding or the 152 pt floor the waveform needs. Same font, same 13 pt size in every locale — the HUD grows instead. Nothing in the HUD has a background, border, hover state or padding that could read as a hit target.

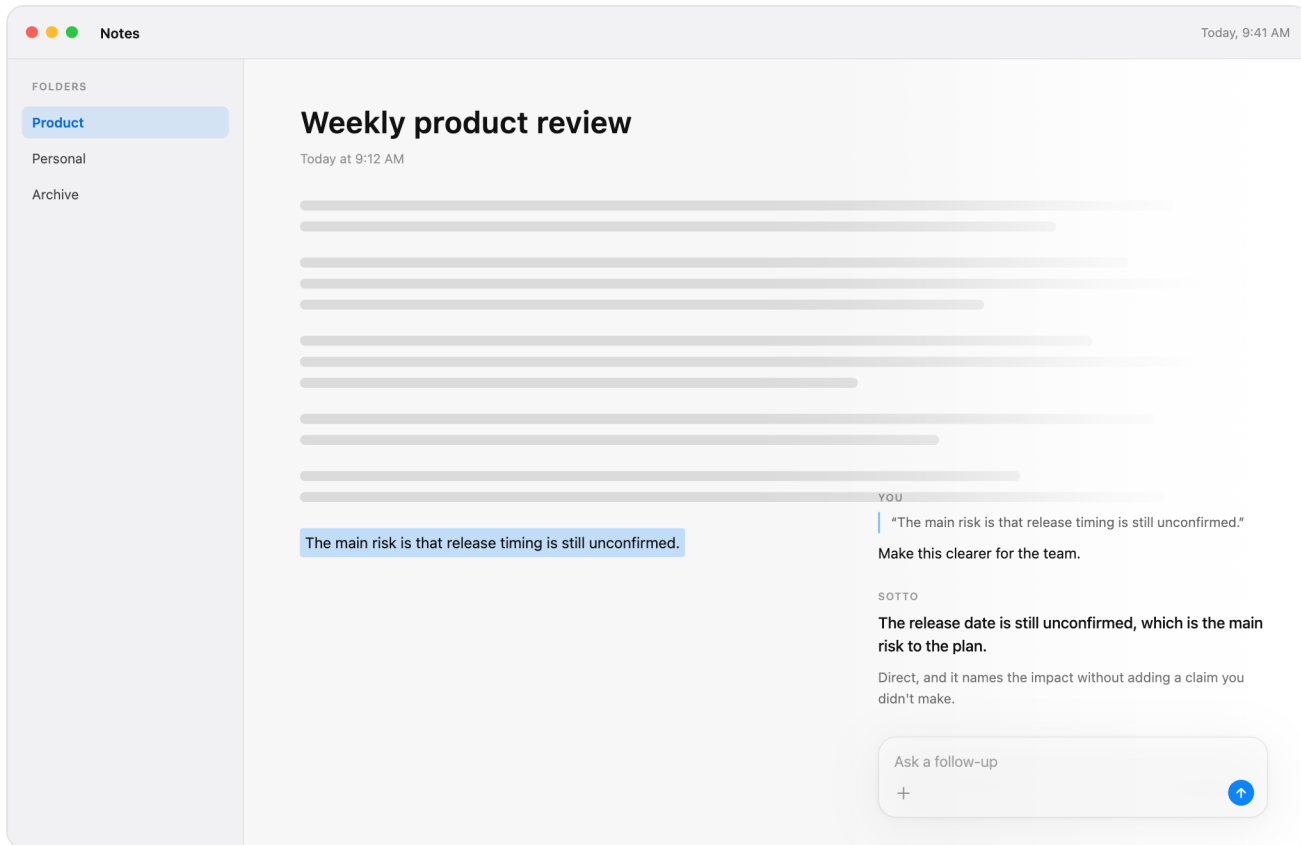
MENU BAR · IDLE / ACTIVE, REAL SIZE



canvas 18 × 18 pt (1.000) · glyph 15.6 × 7.2 pt (0.867 × 0.400), r 3.6 pt (0.200) · aspect 2.17 : 1

idle stroke 1.5 pt (0.083) – floor, do not go thinner · interior 4.2 pt (0.233) · active solid fill, ink 112 pt² of 324 pt² (0.347)

pure black-on-transparent template image, both states · one capsule, not two — see [the four candidates](#)



Wash 560 pt wide, full height, no border and no shadow · six blur passes at 1 / 2 / 4 / 8 / 16 / 30 pt, each masked in over its own 20–28% band so blur accumulates instead of stepping · white ramp 0% → 100% across the same span, opaque at 90%

Composer 390 × 81 pt · radius 18 pt · line 1 placeholder 15 pt · line 2 controls 26 pt: plus glyph 19 pt at 42% ink with no container, send 26 pt circle #0A84FF · no chat picker

Glass: fill 55% white, blur 34 pt, saturate 180%, stroke 0.5 pt @ 9% black, inner top highlight 0.5 pt @ 85% white, shadow 0 10 28 @ 10% · shown at 50%

Inside the app the note is the subject, so the chat picker is gone. The composer keeps the overlay bar's two controls in the same corners at the same 26 pt, which is what makes the two surfaces read as one product.

Everything above is drawn in a browser, which cannot produce several of the materials this design specifies. The measurements and behaviour hold; the following surfaces will look different once built natively, and in each case the built version is the intent.

CORNERS

Squircles, not rounded rectangles

Every radius quoted above is a continuous corner curve, the same construction the system uses for windows and app icons. CSS border-radius is a circular arc, which bulges slightly at the tangent and makes a 16 pt corner read tighter than it should. Build with the platform shape, not a radius value.

MATERIAL

Real liquid glass, not a blurred fill

The bar and the HUD are one system material: it refracts and displaces what is behind it at the edges, brightens specularly along the top, and adapts its own tint to the wallpaper underneath. What is drawn here is a flat white fill over a backdrop blur, which has none of that. Read the percentages as a starting tint, not a recipe.

MOTION

Bars are animated on a fixed loop here

Each bar runs an independent CSS keyframe, so the waveform is decorative rather than driven. In the build the 12 heights come from live input at a 60 Hz sample with the compression curve quoted above, and the resting state is real noise floor. Timing and easing come out of that, not from these loops.

BACKDROP

The chat wash is six discrete blur passes

A true progressive blur ramps its radius continuously across the span. Browsers cannot, so the wash is six masked layers that overlap enough to hide the steps. Natively this is one variable-radius blur, and any faint banding visible in the mockup will not exist.

CONTENT

Everything shown is stand-in content

Note body copy is grey bars, the accent is system blue as a placeholder, and the window chrome is drawn rather than real. Type, spacing and control sizes are specified; the words, colours and screenshots are not decisions.

Assumed platform metrics — 1512 × 982 pt screen, 24 pt menu bar, 18 × 18 pt template canvas — are listed in full on each options page. Accent colours here are macOS system blue as a stand-in; the accent only ever fills the bars and glyphs, never a surface.